

Safe Motherhood

A healthy pregnancy and a safe birth protect both the mother and the baby. Start care early and plan ahead.

For community members

Key messages

- Go to the health centre as soon as you know you are pregnant, and keep going for check-ups.
- Plan where you will give birth and how you will get there before labour starts. Talk to your husband, family and village leaders about transport.
- Eat a variety of foods, drink clean water, and rest.
- Sleep under a bed net every night.
- After the birth, bring your baby for check-ups and immunisation. Breastfeed your baby.

Go to the health centre or hospital straight away if you have

- Heavy bleeding
- A very bad headache, blurred vision, or fits
- Fever or bad-smelling fluid
- The baby moving much less, or not at all
- Waters have broken but labour has not started
- Labour that goes on for a long time

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines.